The Other Beast: America in Prophecy

A Comprehensive Bible Study Guide

Introduction: The Second Beast Emerges

In Revelation 13, we encounter two beasts. The first represents papal Rome, rising from the sea (populated Europe) and ruling for 1,260 years (538-1798 CE). *(This power shares key characteristics with the Little Horn of Daniel 7, studied in a companion guide — both prophecies describe the same papal system from different prophetic angles.)* But just as that power receives its deadly wound in 1798, a second beast emerges—this time from the earth (sparsely populated region). This beast appears harmless, even Christ-like, yet ultimately speaks as a dragon and enforces worship of the first beast.

This is one of the most sobering prophecies in Scripture: A nation founded on Christian principles and civil/religious liberty will eventually betray those very foundations and become the enforcer of the mark of the beast.

Foundation Principle: Appearances deceive. A power can look Christian externally while operating with satanic authority internally.

Study Methodology: Let Scripture define the symbols, identify the power through prophetic characteristics, and understand the warning for God's people today.

Part 1: The Vision of the Second Beast

Revelation 13:11-17 - The Complete Description

Revelation 13:11: "And I beheld **another beast coming up out of the earth**; and he had **two horns like a lamb**, and **he spake as a dragon**."

Three Key Elements:

1. **Rises from the earth** (contrasted with first beast from sea)
2. **Two horns like a lamb** (appears Christ-like)
3. **Speaks as a dragon** (ultimately satanic in action)

Revelation 13:12: "And he exerciseth **all the power of the first beast before him**, and causeth the earth and them which dwell therein to **worship the first beast**, whose deadly wound was healed."

Role: Enforces worship of the first beast (papal power) after its wound heals.

Revelation 13:13: "And he doeth **great wonders**, so that he **maketh fire come down from heaven** on the earth in the sight of men."

Method: Supernatural signs and wonders to deceive.

Revelation 13:14: "And **deceiveth them that dwell on the earth** by the means of those miracles which he had power to do in the sight of the beast; saying to them that dwell on the earth, that they should **make an**

image to the beast, which had the wound by a sword, and did live."

Objective: Create an "image" (copy/likeness) of the first beast's system.

Revelation 13:15: "And he had power to give life unto the image of the beast, that the image of the beast should both **speak**, and cause that **as many as would not worship the image of the beast should be killed**."

Result: Death decree for non-compliance.

Revelation 13:16-17: "And he causeth all, both small and great, rich and poor, free and bond, to **receive a mark in their right hand, or in their foreheads**: And that **no man might buy or sell**, save he that had the mark, or the name of the beast, or the number of his name."

Enforcement: Economic sanctions (can't buy or sell) and ultimately death penalty for those refusing the mark.

The False Prophet Identified

Revelation 19:20: "And the beast was taken, and with him **the false prophet** that wrought miracles before him, with which he deceived them that had received the mark of the beast, and them that worshipped his image. These both were cast alive into a lake of fire burning with brimstone."

Critical Identification: The second beast = **the false prophet**

This isn't merely a religious figure—it's a **nation** operating as a false prophet, leading the world into deception through miraculous signs while appearing Christian.

Part 2: Identifying Mark #1 - Rises from the Earth

Biblical Symbolism: Sea vs. Earth

Revelation 13:1: "And I stood upon the sand of the **sea**, and saw a beast rise up **out of the sea**..."

First Beast = rises from **sea**

Revelation 13:11: "And I beheld another beast **coming up out of the earth**..."

Second Beast = rises from **earth**

What does "sea" represent?

Revelation 17:15: "And he saith unto me, The **waters** which thou sawest, where the whore sitteth, are **peoples, and multitudes, and nations, and tongues**."

Biblical Symbol Established:

- **Sea/Waters** = densely populated areas, many nations/peoples (Revelation 17:15 — directly stated)
- **Earth** (by contrast) = sparsely populated area, wilderness, relatively unpopulated region *(deduced by contrast with the established sea symbol — a standard interpretive principle in prophetic hermeneutics)*

Application: The first beast (papal Rome) arose from the populated regions of Europe—amid the divisions of the Roman Empire, surrounded by established nations.

The second beast arises in a relatively unpopulated area of the world—not from among established kingdoms, but in a wilderness region, a "new world."

Historical Context

1798 CE (when first beast receives deadly wound) - What major nation was emerging in a sparsely populated region of the world?

Answer: The United States of America

- Founded in wilderness territory (from European perspective)
- Native populations sparse compared to Europe
- Proclaimed independence 1776
- Constitution ratified 1788
- Rising to prominence as papal power was wounded (1798)

Identifying Mark #1 Fulfilled: Rises from earth (New World, Americas) rather than sea (Old World, Europe).

Part 3: Identifying Mark #2 - Timing (Around 1798)

Prophetic Synchronization

Revelation 13:10: "He that leadeth into captivity shall go into captivity; he that killeth with the sword must be killed with the sword. Here is the patience and the faith of the saints."

Context: This verse immediately precedes the vision of the second beast (verse 11). It describes the first beast's deadly wound—which occurred in **1798 CE** when Napoleon's General Berthier deposed Pope Pius VI.

Prophetic Pattern: As one power goes down, another rises.

Revelation 13:11: "**And I beheld another beast**..." (Greek: *kai* = "and" — the context of the preceding verse describing the first beast's wound establishes the sequential flow: as one power falls, another rises)

Timeline:

- **1798 CE**: First beast wounded (papal power ends 1,260-year supremacy)
- **Around 1798 CE**: Second beast appears on world stage

Historical Fulfillment:

- **1776**: United States declares independence
- **1788**: U.S. Constitution ratified
- **1798**: United States emerging as distinct nation (same year papal power wounded)
- **1800s**: U.S. begins rise to global prominence

Identifying Mark #2 Fulfilled: Second beast appears on the world scene around 1798 CE, precisely as the first beast is wounded.

Part 4: Identifying Mark #3 - Rises Slowly (No Wings)

Symbolism of Wings in Prophecy

Daniel 7:4: "The first was like a **lion**, and had **eagle's wings**..."

Symbol: **Wings** = rapid conquest, swift rise to power

Babylon (lion with eagle's wings) = conquered rapidly under Nebuchadnezzar

Daniel 7:6: "...a **leopard**, ...upon the back of it **four wings of a fowl**..."

Greece (leopard with four wings) = Alexander the Great conquered the known world in just 10 years—the most rapid conquest in ancient history. Four wings = extraordinary speed.

Revelation 13:11: "And I beheld another beast coming up out of the earth; and he had two horns like a lamb..."

Notice: **No wings mentioned**

Significance: This power rises **gradually, peacefully, without rapid military conquest**—growing slowly over time rather than through swift warfare. *(Note: The absence of wings is one element of the picture; the gradual rise conclusion is confirmed by combining this detail with the historical record of America's development — Scripture and history interpret each other.)*

Historical Fulfillment: United States

1776-1800: Small nation of 13 colonies, population ~5 million **1800-1850**: Westward expansion, gradual growth **1850-1900**: Industrialization, increasing influence **1900-1945**: Emerging world power **1945-Present**: Global superpower

No wings = gradual, steady rise over 150+ years, not rapid conquest like previous empires.

Identifying Mark #3 Fulfilled: Rises slowly and peacefully to power, without the rapid military conquest symbolized by wings.

Part 5: Identifying Mark #4 - Global Power Projection

Worldwide Influence Required

Revelation 13:12: "And he exerciseth **all the power of the first beast before him**, and causeth **the earth and them which dwell therein** to worship the first beast, whose deadly wound was healed."

"All the power of the first beast": The first beast had authority over "all kindreds, and tongues, and nations" (Revelation 13:7).

The second beast must have similar global reach—able to cause "**the earth and them which dwell therein**" (all earth dwellers) to worship.

Revelation 13:7: "...and power was given him [first beast] over **all kindreds, and tongues, and nations**."

The second beast must be able to project its power around the entire world to fulfill the prophecy of enforcing worship globally.

Historical Fulfillment: United States as Global Superpower

Military Presence:

- 750+ military bases in 80+ countries
- Naval fleets in every ocean
- Air power reaching any location within hours
- Nuclear capabilities

Economic Power:

- U.S. dollar as world reserve currency
- Controls international banking systems (IMF, World Bank)
- Economic sanctions can cripple nations
- Corporate influence in virtually every nation

Political Influence:

- United Nations headquarters in New York
- NATO leadership
- Diplomatic relations with nearly every country
- Ability to form international coalitions

Cultural Dominance:

- Hollywood exports American values worldwide
- English as global business language
- Technology giants (Google, Apple, Microsoft, Facebook)
- Social media platforms shaping global opinion

Only One Nation Fits: No other nation that arose around 1798 from a sparsely populated region has achieved this level of global power projection.

Identifying Mark #4 Fulfilled: Possesses supreme global power—military, economic, political, and cultural—able to influence the entire world.

Part 6: Identifying Mark #5 - Lamb-Like (Christian Nation)

The Lamb Symbolism

Revelation 13:11: "And I beheld another beast coming up out of the earth; and he had **two horns like a lamb**..."

What does a lamb represent?

1 Peter 1:18-19: "knowing that you were not redeemed with corruptible things, like silver or gold, from your aimless conduct received by tradition from your fathers, but with the **precious blood of Christ, as of a lamb** without blemish and without spot."

Biblical Symbol Established: **Lamb = Christ**

Application: The second beast has the **appearance of Christ**—it appears as a **Christian nation**, founded on Christian principles, claiming to follow the Lamb.

John 1:29: "The next day John saw Jesus coming toward him, and said, 'Behold! **The Lamb of God** who takes away the sin of the world!'"

The Lamb = Jesus Christ, the Redeemer

Two Horns Like a Lamb = This nation presents itself as Christ-like, Christian in character and profession.

Historical Fulfillment: America as "Christian Nation"

Founding Documents and National Identity Reference God:

- Declaration of Independence: "endowed by their Creator with certain unalienable Rights"
- "In God We Trust" (national motto — appeared on coins from 1864; officially adopted as national motto by Congress in 1956)
- Oath of office: "So help me God"

Historical Identity:

- Settlers fled religious persecution, seeking Christian freedom
- Puritan foundations in New England
- Great Awakenings (religious revivals)
- Protestant majority for most of history
- Missionary sending nation
- Bible societies and Christian publishers

Self-Perception:

- "City on a hill" (Matthew 5:14 — John Winthrop applied this phrase to the Massachusetts Bay Colony in his 1630 sermon *A Model of Christian Charity*; this is America's historical self-perception, not a biblical identification of America)
- "One nation under God" (Pledge of Allegiance)
- "Christian nation" rhetoric in politics
- Appeals to Providence and divine blessing

Identifying Mark #5 Fulfilled: The United States has been a professedly Christian nation, appearing as a "lamb" (Christ-like) to the world.

Part 7: Identifying Mark #6 - Two Horns (Separation of Church and State)

Horns Represent Kingdoms/Powers

Daniel 7:24: "And the **ten horns** out of this kingdom are **ten kings** that shall arise..." *(The angel explicitly interprets the horns of Daniel's fourth beast as kings/powers, establishing the horn symbol as representing governing authorities throughout apocalyptic prophecy.)*

Biblical Symbol Established: **Horns = kingdoms, kings, or governing powers**

Revelation 13:11: "...and he had **two horns** like a lamb..."

Question: What are the **two governing powers** of this lamb-like nation?

The Principle of Separation

Mark 12:17: "And Jesus answering said unto them, **Render to Caesar the things that are Caesar's, and to God the things that are God's**. And they marvelled at him."

Two Distinct Realms:

1. **Civil authority** ("Caesar" = government, state)
2. **Religious authority** ("God" = church, faith)

Jesus established the principle of **separation between civil and religious power**.

John 18:36: "Jesus answered, **My kingdom is not of this world**. If My kingdom were of this world, My servants would fight, so that I should not be delivered to the Jews; but now My kingdom is not from here."

Christ's Kingdom Principles:

- Not enforced by civil power
- Not of this world's political system
- Freedom of conscience
- No compulsion in faith

The Two Horns of America

First Horn: **Republicanism/Civil Liberty**

- Government by the people
- Democratic principles
- Civil rights and freedoms
- Constitutional protections

Second Horn: **Protestantism/Religious Liberty**

- Freedom of religion
- No established state church
- Liberty of conscience
- Separation of church and state

First Amendment (1791): "Congress shall make no law respecting an establishment of religion, or prohibiting the free exercise thereof..."

Historical Uniqueness: America was among the first nations in modern history to **constitutionally codify** the separation of church and state—enshrining it as a foundational legal right, not merely a tolerated practice. The Netherlands' Union of Utrecht (1579) had established religious toleration earlier, but America's First Amendment (1791) made it a binding constitutional guarantee, setting a new global standard for religious liberty.

Previous Systems:

- **Papal Rome**: Church controlled state

- **European monarchies**: State church systems (Anglican, Lutheran, Catholic)
- **Islamic nations**: Sharia law (religious law enforced by state)
- **Ancient kingdoms**: King as divine or religious head

America's Innovation: Two separate horns (powers)—civil and religious—operating independently, both protecting liberty.

Identifying Mark #6 Fulfilled: Founded on the separation of church and state, giving both civil and religious freedom—a distinctly Christian ethic drawn from Scripture.

Part 8: The Complete Identification

All Seven Marks Point to One Nation

Identifying Characteristics of the Two-Horned Lamb Beast/False Prophet:

1. ✓ **A nation** (not an individual or religious organization)
2. ✓ **Arises in a new part of the world, sparsely populated** (Americas, not Europe)
3. ✓ **Appears on world scene around 1798 CE** (U.S. Constitution 1788, emerging as papal power wounded 1798)
4. ✓ **Rises slowly over time into power** (no wings = gradual growth, not rapid conquest)
5. ✓ **Global power projection** (military, economic, political, cultural dominance worldwide)
6. ✓ **Professedly Christian nation** (lamb-like appearance, Christian identity and rhetoric)
7. ✓ **Founded on separation of church and state** (two horns = civil and religious liberty)

Only One Nation in History Fits All Seven Identifying Marks: **The United States of America**

This isn't anti-American sentiment—it's **biblical prophecy**. God reveals this not to condemn Americans, but to **warn His people** of what's coming so they can prepare and remain faithful.

Part 9: But He Spoke as a Dragon

The Transformation Prophesied

Revelation 13:11: "And I beheld another beast coming up out of the earth; and he had two horns **like a lamb**, and **he spake as a dragon**."

The Tragic Shift:

- **Appearance**: Like a lamb (Christ-like, Christian)
- **Actions**: Like a dragon (satanic, oppressive)

Revelation 12:9: "And the great dragon was cast out, that old serpent, called the **Devil, and Satan**..."

Speaking as a dragon = speaking and acting with satanic authority, using satanic methods.

The Prophecy: America will **betray its founding principles**. The nation founded on civil and religious liberty will **speak as a dragon**—enforcing religious worship through civil power.

The False Prophet Nature

Revelation 19:20: "And the beast was taken, and with him **the false prophet** that wrought miracles before him, with which he deceived them that had received the mark of the beast, and them that worshipped his image..."

What is a False Prophet?

Matthew 7:15: "Beware of **false prophets**, who come to you **in sheep's clothing**, but inwardly they are **ravenous wolves**."

Characteristics:

- **External appearance**: Sheep/lamb (harmless, godly)
- **Internal reality**: Ravenous wolves (destructive, dangerous)
- **Method**: Deception (looks like truth, sounds Christian)

America as False Prophet:

- **Claims**: Christian nation, religious liberty, "In God We Trust"
- **Reality**: Will enforce worship through civil power
- **Method**: Looks Christian while acting satanically

Matthew 7:21-23: "Not everyone who says to Me, '**Lord, Lord**,' shall enter the kingdom of heaven, but he who does the will of My Father in heaven. Many will say to Me in that day, 'Lord, Lord, have we not **prophesied in Your name**, cast out demons in Your name, and done **many wonders** in Your name?' And then I will declare to them, '**I never knew you; depart from Me, you who practice lawlessness!**'"

The Warning:

- Claiming Christ's name ("Lord, Lord")
- Doing miracles ("many wonders in Your name")
- Yet practicing **lawlessness** (breaking God's law)
- **Jesus doesn't know them** (not truly His followers)

Application *(by analogy)*: Just as individuals can claim Christ's name while practicing lawlessness, a nation built on Christian profession can invoke God's name and perform apparent wonders—yet through its policies and laws practice lawlessness and not truly follow Christ.

Part 10: Fire from Heaven - The Counterfeit Pentecost

The Miraculous Deception

Revelation 13:13: "And he doeth **great wonders**, so that he **maketh fire come down from heaven** on the earth in the sight of men."

Question: Why specifically "fire from heaven"? What does this mimic?

The True Pentecost

Acts 2:1-4:

- **Verse 1**: "When the Day of Pentecost had fully come, they were all with one accord in one place."

- **Verse 2**: "And suddenly there came a sound **from heaven**, as of a rushing mighty wind, and it filled the whole house where they were sitting."
- **Verse 3**: "Then appeared to them divided tongues, **as of fire**, and one sat upon each of them."
- **Verse 4**: "And they were all **filled with the Holy Spirit** and began to speak with other tongues, as the Spirit gave them utterance."

True Pentecost:

- **Tongues as of fire** (*hōsei pyr* — Acts 2:3) = fire-like appearance, sign of Holy Spirit's presence *(note: this was a visual appearance likened to fire, not literal fire descending from the sky — the contrast with Revelation 13:13's literal miracle is intentional)*
- **Empowerment** for witnessing truth
- **Authentic** spiritual experience from God

The Counterfeit Fire

Revelation 13:13: "And he doeth great wonders, so that he **maketh fire come down from heaven**..."

Purpose: **Counterfeit** the true work of the Holy Spirit—making false miracles appear to be from God.

2 Thessalonians 2:9: "The coming of the lawless one is according to the working of Satan, with all power, signs, and **lying wonders**."

"Lying wonders" = genuine supernatural phenomena, but from the wrong source (Satan, not God). They look real, feel authentic, produce results—but lead people away from truth.

Satan's Fire from Heaven

Job 1:8, 11-12:

- **Verse 8**: "And the LORD said unto Satan, Hast thou considered my servant Job..."
- **Verse 11**: "But [Satan responds] put forth thine hand now, and touch all that he hath, and he will curse thee to thy face."
- **Verse 12**: "And the LORD said unto Satan, Behold, all that he hath is in thy power..."

Job 1:16: "While he was yet speaking, there came also another, and said, **The fire of God is fallen from heaven**, and hath burned up the sheep, and the servants, and consumed them..."

Critical Point: Satan was the agent behind fire from heaven that a servant mistakenly called "**fire of God**" (Job 1:12 — God permitted, Satan acted). The servant's attribution was wrong, but the supernatural event was real.

- It looked supernatural ✓
- It came from heaven ✓
- Observers attributed it to God ✓
- But it was **actually from Satan** ✓

The Warning: Not every supernatural manifestation claiming to be from God actually is. Satan can produce real miracles, real fire, real wonders—that look divine but serve his purposes.

Application: The second beast (America) will be involved in producing miraculous signs—possibly through technology, possibly through spiritual deception, possibly both—that will convince people these are divine endorsements of false worship.

Part 11: The Image to the Beast

What Is the Image?

Revelation 13:14: "And deceiveth them that dwell on the earth by the means of those miracles which he had power to do in the sight of the beast; saying to them that dwell on the earth, that they should **make an image to the beast**, which had the wound by a sword, and did live."

"Image" = likeness, copy, replica

Image to the beast = a copy of the first beast's system

What characterized the first beast (papal Rome)?

- **Union of church and state** (religious authority enforced by civil power)
- **Persecution** of those who wouldn't conform
- **Enforcement of religious dogma** through law
- **Claims of spiritual authority** backed by sword
- **Tradition elevated above Scripture**

The Image = **America creating a union of church and state**, enforcing religious observance through civil law—betraying its founding principle of separation of church and state.

Giving Life to the Image

Revelation 13:15: "And he had power to **give life unto the image** of the beast, that the image of the beast should both **speak**, and cause that as many as would not worship the image of the beast should be **killed**."

"Give life" = activate, empower, make functional

The image will:

1. **Speak** (make laws, issue decrees)
2. **Enforce worship** (religious conformity required)
3. **Execute dissenters** (death penalty for non-compliance)

Historical Parallel: During 538-1798 CE, the papal system:

- Spoke authoritatively (papal decrees)
- Enforced worship (mass attendance required by law)
- Executed dissenters (Inquisition, martyrdom of millions)

Future Fulfillment: America will create a similar system:

- Religious laws enacted by Congress
- Worship enforced through legislation
- Persecution of those maintaining biblical truth

- Eventually, death decree for the faithful

This is "speaking as a dragon"—using civil power to enforce religious worship, exactly what papal Rome did.

Part 12: The Mark, the Name, and the Number

The Threefold Identification

Revelation 13:16-17: "And he causeth all, both small and great, rich and poor, free and bond, to receive a **mark in their right hand, or in their foreheads**: And that no man might **buy or sell**, save he that had **the mark**, or **the name of the beast**, or **the number of his name**."

Three Ways to Identify with the Beast:

1. **The mark** (sign of allegiance)
2. **The name** (identity of the power)
3. **The number** (666 - covered in previous study)

All three refer to the same system, just different aspects of identification.

Economic Enforcement

"No man might buy or sell" = economic sanctions

Not just spiritual pressure—practical, daily survival impacted:

- Can't purchase food
- Can't pay bills
- Can't maintain employment
- Can't conduct business
- Total economic exclusion

Purpose: Force compliance through economic pressure. Most people will choose survival over principle.

Revelation 13:16: "And he causeth **all**, both small and great, rich and poor, free and bond..."

Universal enforcement:

- **Small and great** = common people and elites
- **Rich and poor** = all economic classes
- **Free and bond** = all social statuses

No exceptions. Everyone must choose.

Location: Hand or Forehead

Right hand = actions, work, deeds (what you do) **Forehead** = mind, thoughts, beliefs (what you believe)

Two Types of Compliance:

1. **Forehead** = genuine belief in the false system (deceived, truly convinced)
2. **Hand** = outward compliance without belief (pragmatic conformity, "going along" for survival)

Both receive the mark. God requires not just right actions, but right belief and conscious choice.

Part 13: The Watchman's Responsibility

God's Call to Warn

Ezekiel 3:17-18: "Son of man, I have made you a **watchman** for the house of Israel; therefore **hear a word from My mouth, and give them warning from Me**: When I say to the wicked, 'You shall surely die,' and **you give him no warning**, nor speak to warn the wicked from his wicked way, to save his life, that same wicked man shall die in his iniquity; but **his blood I will require at your hand**."

The Watchman's Duty:

- Hear God's warning (study prophecy)
- **Give the warning** to others (share truth)
- Speak plainly (don't soften the message)

The Consequence of Silence:

- The wicked die in their sin
- **Their blood is required of the silent watchman**
- We bear responsibility for those we failed to warn

Isaiah 58:1: "**Cry aloud, spare not**; Lift up your voice like a trumpet; **tell My people their transgression**, and the house of Jacob their sins."

Not "whisper quietly" but "cry aloud, spare not":

- Urgent warning
- Clear message
- No watering down truth
- Tell God's people their danger

Matthew 7:23: "And then I will declare to them, 'I never knew you; depart from Me, you who **practice lawlessness**!'"

The issue: **Lawlessness** (breaking God's law despite religious profession)

The watchman must warn about:

- False worship
- Breaking God's commandments
- Following tradition over Scripture
- The coming mark of the beast
- The need to prepare now

Part 14: The Falling Away Explained

Apostasy Predicted

2 Thessalonians 2:3: "Let no one deceive you by any means; for that Day will not come unless **the falling away comes first**, and the man of sin is revealed, the son of perdition."

"Falling away" (Greek: *apostasia*) = apostasy, rebellion, departure from truth

This happened gradually:

- Tradition added to Scripture
- Pagan practices adopted
- God's law changed
- Human mediators inserted
- Papal authority established

But the principle continues: Falling away didn't stop in the Dark Ages—it continues and will intensify before Christ's return.

2 Thessalonians 2:5: "Do you not remember that when I was still with you **I told you these things**?"

Paul warned the early church that this was coming. It wasn't a surprise—it was **prophesied**.

Wolves Among the Flock

Acts 20:29-31: "For I know this, that after my departure **savage wolves will come in among you, not sparing the flock**. Also **from among yourselves men will rise up**, speaking perverse things, to draw away the disciples after themselves. Therefore **watch**, and remember that for three years **I did not cease to warn everyone night and day with tears**."

Paul's Warning:

- **External threat**: Wolves from outside ("come in among you")
- **Internal threat**: False teachers from within ("from among yourselves")
- **The method**: Speaking perverse (twisted) things
- **The result**: Drawing disciples away from truth

Paul's response: **Constant warning for three years with tears**—this is the heart of a true shepherd who sees danger coming.

Part 15: False Prophets and Lying Dreams

God's Judgment on Deception

Jeremiah 23:32: "Behold, **I am against those who prophesy false dreams**, says the Lord, and tell them, and **cause My people to err** by their lies and by their recklessness. Yet I did not send them or command them; therefore they shall not profit this people at all, says the Lord."

God is against:

- False dreams/visions (claiming divine revelation)
- Causing people to err (leading into error)
- Lies and recklessness (deception and carelessness)

They were not sent by God—self-appointed, following their own hearts.

Ezekiel 13:2-3: "Son of man, prophesy against the prophets of Israel who prophesy, and say to **those who prophesy out of their own heart**, 'Hear the word of the Lord!' Thus says the Lord God: **Woe to the foolish prophets, who follow their own spirit and have seen nothing!**"

False prophets:

- Prophesy from their own heart (not God's word)
- Follow their own spirit (not the Holy Spirit)
- Have seen nothing (no true revelation from God)

The danger: They sound spiritual, claim divine authority, but lead people away from God's actual word.

The Deceitful Heart

Jeremiah 17:9: "The **heart is deceitful above all things**, and desperately wicked; who can know it?"

We cannot trust:

- Our feelings
- Our intuition
- Our personal experiences
- Popular opinion
- Majority vote
- Tradition

We must rely on: God's Word alone (Sola Scriptura).

Part 16: Testing Prophets and Miracles

The Biblical Test

Deuteronomy 13:1-3: "If there arises among you a prophet or a dreamer of dreams, and he **gives you a sign or a wonder**, and the **sign or the wonder comes to pass**, of which he spoke to you, saying, '**Let us go after other gods**'—which you have not known—'and let us serve them,' **you shall not listen** to the words of that prophet or that dreamer of dreams, for **the Lord your God is testing you** to know whether you love the Lord your God with all your heart and with all your soul."

Critical Principle: **Even if the miracle comes to pass**, if the teaching contradicts God's Word, **reject the prophet**.

The Test of a True Prophet:

1. **Miracles are NOT the test** (false prophets can do real miracles)
2. **Doctrine IS the test** (do they lead toward God's law or away from it?)
3. **God allows false miracles** as a test of our love for Him

Application to Second Beast:

- Will do great wonders ✓

- Fire from heaven ✓
- Appears Christian ✓
- **BUT leads people to worship the beast** (away from God's truth)
- **Reject it** regardless of miracles

The Law and Testimony Test

Isaiah 8:20: "**To the law and to the testimony**: if they speak not according to this word, it is because **there is no light in them**."

Two-Part Test:

1. **The Law** (God's Ten Commandments, Old Testament)
2. **The Testimony** (testimony of Jesus, New Testament)

If teaching contradicts Scripture (law + testimony), there is **no light** in it—regardless of:

- Miracles performed
- Popularity achieved
- Emotions felt
- Claims of divine authority

This is the final safeguard against deception in the last days.

Part 17: Order, Not Confusion

The Holy Spirit's Character

1 Corinthians 14:32-33: "And **the spirits of the prophets are subject to the prophets**. For **God is not the author of confusion but of peace**, as in all the churches of the saints."

True Prophets:

- Have **self-control** ("spirits subject to prophets")
- Don't lose control or act erratically
- Bring **peace**, not confusion
- Consistent with Scripture

False Manifestations:

- Uncontrollable experiences
- Emotional manipulation
- Confusion and chaos
- Contradiction with God's Word

The Test: Does it bring biblical clarity and peace, or emotional confusion?

The Pattern of True vs. False

True Holy Spirit Work:

- Glorifies Jesus (John 16:14)
- Leads into all truth (John 16:13)
- Brings conviction of sin (John 16:8)
- Points to Scripture (2 Peter 1:21)
- Produces fruit: love, joy, peace, patience, etc. (Galatians 5:22-23)
- Order and self-control (1 Corinthians 14:33, 40)

False Spirit Work:

- Draws attention to signs/wonders
- Leads away from truth
- Emphasizes feelings over doctrine
- Elevates experience above Scripture
- Produces emotionalism, fear, confusion
- Chaos and loss of control

The second beast will produce powerful spiritual manifestations that many will accept as Holy Spirit—but they fail the biblical test.

Part 18: The Wall of Separation Crumbling

America's Foundational Principle Under Attack

Historical Foundation: The United States was built on separation of church and state—the "wall of separation" protecting both religious and civil liberty.

The Prophecy: America will **speak as a dragon**—betraying this principle, using civil power to enforce religious observance.

Evidence of Change:

Supreme Court Chief Justice William Rehnquist (*Wallace v. Jaffree*, 1985 — dissenting opinion): "The wall of separation between church and state is a metaphor based on bad history, a metaphor which has proved useless as a guide to judging. **It should be frankly and explicitly abandoned**." *(Note: This was a dissent, not a majority ruling — but it reflects a judicial philosophy that has gained increasing traction.)*

Supreme Court Justice Antonin Scalia (*Employment Division v. Smith*, 1990): Wrote the majority opinion ruling that neutral, generally applicable laws need not grant religious exemptions — a ruling that effectively narrowed First Amendment protections for religious practice, even when not intentionally targeting religion.

Analysis:

- America's highest court narrowing First Amendment religious protections
- Precedent allowing civil law to override religious practice without strict scrutiny
- Gradual erosion of the religious liberty the two-horned beast was founded upon

Current Trends:

- Religious Right political movements
- "Christian nation" rhetoric increasing

- Calls for religious laws (prayer mandates, religious symbols in public)
- Persecution of minorities not conforming to "Christian values"
- Ecumenical movements seeking unity through compromise

The Image Taking Shape

The image to the beast (church-state union like papal Rome) is forming:

- Protestant churches seeking political power
- Politicians courting religious vote
- Laws based on religious tradition rather than Scripture
- Economic pressure on non-conformists
- Increasing intolerance of dissent

The "lamb" is beginning to "speak as a dragon."

Part 19: The Coming Crisis

The Sequence of Events

Based on Revelation 13:11-17, here's the prophetic timeline:

1. Second Beast Rises (1776-1798) ✓ **FULFILLED**

- United States emerges as nation
- Founded on civil and religious liberty

2. First Beast's Wound Heals (1929-present) ✓ **IN PROGRESS**

- Vatican restored as sovereign state (1929)
- Papal influence increasing globally
- Ecumenical movement gaining strength

3. Second Beast Speaks as Dragon (beginning now) ⚠️ **STARTING**

- Erosion of church-state separation
- Religious political movements gaining power
- Supreme Court decisions weakening First Amendment

4. Image to Beast Formed (near future) ⏳ **COMING**

- Church-state union established in America
- Protestant churches unite with Catholic Church
- Religious laws enacted by Congress
- Religious conformity mandated as catalyst

5. Mark of the Beast Enforced (near future) ⏳ **COMING**

- Worship mandated by law
- Economic sanctions ("no man might buy or sell")
- Death decree for non-compliance

- Universal enforcement attempted

6. Persecution of Saints (near future) ⏳ **COMING**

- Those keeping God's commandments targeted
- Those refusing to compromise biblical truth persecuted
- Faithful believers martyred
- "Patience and faith of the saints" tested (Revelation 14:12)

7. Christ Returns (climax) ⏳ **FUTURE**

- Beast and false prophet destroyed
- Saints delivered
- Kingdom of God established

We are somewhere between stages 2 and 3—the wound is healing, and America is beginning to speak as a dragon.

Part 20: The Final Warning and Call

Three Angels' Messages (Preview)

The warning about the second beast connects directly to **Revelation 14:6-12**, the Three Angels' Messages (subject of future study):

First Angel (Revelation 14:7): "Fear God and give glory to Him, for the hour of His judgment has come; and **worship Him who made heaven and earth**, the sea and springs of water."

Call: Worship the Creator (according to His Word, not human tradition)

Second Angel (Revelation 14:8): "Babylon is fallen, is fallen, that great city, because she has made all nations drink of the wine of the wrath of her fornication."

Call: Come out of false religious systems (Revelation 18:4)

Third Angel (Revelation 14:9-10): "If anyone **worships the beast and his image, and receives his mark** on his forehead or on his hand, he himself shall also drink of the wine of the wrath of God..."

Call: Refuse the mark of the beast, regardless of consequences

Revelation 14:12: "Here is the patience of the saints; here are **those who keep the commandments of God and the faith of Jesus**."

God's Faithful Remnant:

- Keep **all** God's commandments (without alteration or compromise)
- Maintain **faith of Jesus** (trust Him through persecution)
- Refuse to worship beast or receive mark
- Endure to the end

The Choice Before Us

Two Systems:

God's System:

- Scripture alone (Sola Scriptura)
- God's law unchanged
- Worship according to His commandments
- Christ as only Mediator
- Salvation by grace through faith
- Liberty of conscience

Beast's System:

- Tradition over Scripture
- God's law changed
- Worship according to human tradition
- Human priests as mediators
- Salvation by works/sacraments
- Forced conformity

The Test:

- **Forehead** (belief) or **Hand** (action)
- **Seal of God** or **Mark of Beast**
- **Truth** or **Deception**
- **Obedience** or **Compromise**
- **Life** or **Death**

Revelation 13:9-10: "**If any man have an ear, let him hear**. He that leadeth into captivity shall go into captivity: he that killeth with the sword must be killed with the sword. **Here is the patience and the faith of the saints**."

The call to hear = spiritual discernment to understand these truths

The call to patience and faith = endure through coming persecution, trusting God's justice

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Conclusion: America's Prophetic Role

Summary of the Prophecy

The United States of America is the second beast of Revelation 13:

- Rose from sparsely populated earth (Americas) around 1798
- Appeared lamb-like (Christian nation, civil/religious liberty)
- Grew slowly without rapid conquest (no wings)
- Achieved global superpower status
- Founded on separation of church and state (two horns)

But will betray its founding principles:

- Speak as a dragon (use force in religion)
- Create image to the beast (church-state union)
- Enforce worship of first beast (papal authority)
- Implement mark of the beast (economic/legal enforcement)
- Persecute God's faithful people
- Lead the world into final deception

This Is Not Anti-American

Critical Understanding: This prophecy is not about hating America or condemning Americans. It's about:

1. **Biblical truth** - God's Word reveals these events
2. **Warning** - So believers can prepare
3. **Love** - Warning is an act of love (Ezekiel 3:17-18)
4. **Preparation** - Understanding what's coming prevents deception
5. **Call to faithfulness** - Stand for truth regardless of national loyalty

Many sincere Christians in America will be deceived because they cannot imagine their nation fulfilling this role. **Patriotism must never supersede biblical truth.**

The Urgent Need to Prepare

What Should We Do?

1. **Study prophecy deeply** - Understand the times (1 Chronicles 12:32)
2. **Ground yourself in Scripture** - Only defense against deception (Isaiah 8:20)
3. **Keep God's commandments** - All ten, including the Sabbath (Revelation 14:12)
4. **Come out of Babylon** - Separate from false religious systems (Revelation 18:4)
5. **Warn others** - Be a faithful watchman (Ezekiel 3:17-18)
6. **Prepare for persecution** - Trials are coming (Matthew 24:9)
7. **Trust God completely** - He will deliver His faithful (Daniel 3:17-18)
8. **Wait patiently** - Justice is certain (Revelation 13:10)

2 Timothy 3:1, 5: "But know this, that in the last days perilous times will come... having a form of godliness but denying its power. **From such people turn away!**"

The form of godliness without power = Christianity in appearance only, without transformation by God's Word and Spirit.

The command: **Turn away**—separate from false Christianity, even when it's popular, patriotic, or politically powerful.

The Final Test of Loyalty

Ultimately, this prophecy reveals the final test:

Whom will you obey when civil law contradicts God's law?

Acts 5:29: "But Peter and the other apostles answered and said: '**We ought to obey God rather than men**.'"

When America (second beast) enforces worship of the papacy (first beast) through religious laws, economic sanctions, and eventually death decrees, **God's people must choose obedience to His Word over compliance with human law**.

This is the patience and faith of the saints.

Daniel 3:17-18: "If that is the case, our God whom we serve is able to deliver us from the burning fiery furnace, and He will deliver us from your hand, O king. **But if not**, let it be known to you, O king, that **we do not serve your gods**, nor will we worship the gold image which you have set up."

Faith like Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego:

- Trust God can deliver ✓
- But even if He doesn't ✓
- **Still refuse to compromise** ✓

This is the faith needed for the final crisis.

The choice is clear. The warning is given. The hour is late.

Will you have ears to hear?

Appendix: Study Questions for Personal Reflection

Part 1: The Vision

1. According to Revelation 13:11, where does the second beast rise from (earth or sea)?
2. What do the two horns of the second beast look like?
3. How does the second beast speak (like a lamb or like a dragon)?
4. What does Revelation 13:12 say the second beast causes earth dwellers to do?
5. According to Revelation 13:13, what miracle does the second beast perform?
6. What does the second beast tell earth dwellers to make (Revelation 13:14)?
7. What power does the image of the beast receive (Revelation 13:15)?
8. What happens to those who won't worship the image (Revelation 13:15)?
9. According to Revelation 13:16-17, where is the mark placed?
10. What economic restriction is placed on those without the mark?

Part 2: False Prophet Identification

11. In Revelation 19:20, what name is given to the second beast?
12. According to Revelation 19:20, what two entities are cast into the lake of fire? (Note: The dragon/Satan is cast in separately at Revelation 20:10 — a distinct, later event.)
13. Is the second beast an individual or a nation? Explain using prophetic symbols.

Part 3-4: Geographic and Timing Marks

14. According to Revelation 17:15, what do "waters" represent in prophecy?
15. What does "earth" represent by contrast (sparsely or densely populated)?
16. What year did the first beast receive its deadly wound?
17. What nation arose in a sparsely populated region around 1798?

18. Why is the timing of the second beast's rise significant?

Part 5: Rise to Power

19. What do "wings" symbolize in Daniel's prophecies (Daniel 7:4, 6)?
20. Does the second beast have wings mentioned?
21. What does the absence of wings indicate about its rise to power?
22. How did the United States rise to power differently than ancient empires?

Part 6: Global Power

23. According to Revelation 13:12, how much power does the second beast exercise?
24. What does Revelation 13:7 say about the first beast's authority?
25. Must the second beast have global reach to fulfill prophecy? Why?
26. List four ways America projects power globally.

Part 7: Lamb Symbolism

27. According to 1 Peter 1:19, who does the lamb represent?
28. What does "two horns like a lamb" indicate about the second beast's appearance?
29. Was the United States founded as a professedly Christian nation?
30. Give three examples of Christian identity in American founding documents or symbols.

Part 8: Two Horns Explained

31. According to Daniel 7:24, what do "horns" represent in prophecy?
32. What does Jesus teach in Mark 12:17 about civil and religious authority?
33. What did Jesus say about His kingdom in John 18:36?
34. What are the "two horns" (two governing powers) of the United States?
35. What does the First Amendment establish regarding religion?
36. What was historically significant about America's constitutional codification of church-state separation, and which earlier example (hint: 1579) had established religious toleration before it?

Part 9: Complete Identification

37. List all seven identifying marks of the second beast.
38. What one nation fits all seven characteristics?
39. Is identifying America in prophecy anti-American? Why or why not?
40. What is the purpose of this prophetic revelation?

Part 10: Speaking as a Dragon

41. What does the second beast speak like (Revelation 13:11)?
42. Who is the dragon according to Revelation 12:9?
43. What does "speaking as a dragon" mean regarding the beast's actions?
44. According to Matthew 7:15, what do false prophets wear externally?
45. What are they internally?
46. In Matthew 7:21-23, what do the rejected people claim to have done?
47. What does Jesus call their actions despite their religious claims?

Part 11: Fire from Heaven

48. What miracle does the second beast perform (Revelation 13:13)?
49. What biblical event involved fire from heaven in a positive sense (Acts 2:1-4)?
50. In Job 1:16, who actually sent fire from heaven that was called "fire of God"?
51. Can Satan produce real supernatural signs? Provide Scripture.
52. According to 2 Thessalonians 2:9, what empowers lying wonders?

Part 12: The Image to the Beast

53. What does the second beast tell people to make (Revelation 13:14)?
54. What is an "image" (copy, original, or opposite)?
55. What characterized the first beast's system (church-state union or separation)?
56. What will the image to the beast be in America?
57. According to Revelation 13:15, what three things will the image do?
58. Does this parallel what papal Rome did during 538-1798? How?

Part 13: The Mark

59. According to Revelation 13:16, what three identifiers are mentioned?
60. What economic restriction is placed on those without the mark?
61. What does "no man might buy or sell" mean practically?
62. What two locations can the mark be placed (Revelation 13:16)?
63. What does the "forehead" represent (actions or beliefs)?
64. What does the "hand" represent (actions or beliefs)?
65. Can someone receive the mark without truly believing in the system?

Part 14: Watchman's Duty

66. According to Ezekiel 3:17, what has God made the prophet?
67. What happens if the watchman doesn't warn the wicked (Ezekiel 3:18)?
68. Whose blood will be required of the silent watchman?
69. How does Isaiah 58:1 say we should deliver the warning (quietly or crying aloud)?
70. According to Matthew 7:23, what is the core issue Jesus addresses?

Part 15: The Falling Away

71. According to 2 Thessalonians 2:3, what must come before Christ returns?
72. What does "falling away" (apostasia) mean?
73. In Acts 20:29, what does Paul warn will come into the church?
74. According to Acts 20:30, where will some false teachers come from?
75. How long did Paul warn the church (Acts 20:31)?

Part 16: False Prophets

76. According to Jeremiah 23:32, what is God against?
77. In Ezekiel 13:2-3, where do false prophets get their messages?
78. According to Jeremiah 17:9, what is deceitful above all things?
79. Can we trust our hearts/feelings to determine truth? Why or why not?

Part 17: Testing Prophets

80. In Deuteronomy 13:1-2, what does the false prophet do that comes to pass?
81. What does the false prophet then tell people to do (Deuteronomy 13:2)?
82. Should we listen to this prophet even though the miracle happened (Deuteronomy 13:3)?
83. Why does God allow false prophets to do real miracles?
84. According to Isaiah 8:20, what is the test of truth?
85. What are the two parts of this test (law and what)?

Part 18: Order vs. Confusion

86. According to 1 Corinthians 14:32, are true prophets in control of themselves?
87. According to 1 Corinthians 14:33, is God the author of confusion or peace?
88. List three characteristics of true Holy Spirit work.
89. List three characteristics of false spirit manifestations.

Part 19: Wall of Separation

90. What founding principle did America establish regarding church and state?
91. What did Supreme Court Chief Justice Rehnquist say about the wall of separation?
92. What did the Supreme Court rule in Employment Division v. Smith (1990), and how did it affect First Amendment religious liberty protections?
93. Are these statements supporting or undermining the founding principle?
94. List three current trends showing erosion of church-state separation.

Part 20: Coming Crisis

95. List the seven stages of prophetic events from Revelation 13:11-17.
96. Which stages have been fulfilled completely?
97. Which stage are we in now?
98. What will be the catalyst for the image to the beast (religious conformity laws)?
99. What does Revelation 14:12 say about God's end-time people?

Conclusion: Application

100. Is this prophecy condemning Americans or warning believers? Explain.
101. What must we choose when civil law contradicts God's law (Acts 5:29)?
102. According to Daniel 3:17-18, what was the faith of Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego?
103. What eight things should we do to prepare for the coming crisis?
104. Can patriotism supersede biblical truth? Why or why not?
105. Will you obey God rather than man when the test comes?

Recommended Further Study

To continue understanding end-time prophecy, study these topics:

1. **Revelation 14:6-12** - The Three Angels' Messages (God's final warning)
2. **The Mark of the Beast** - Detailed study of what it is and how to avoid it
3. **The Seal of God** - God's sign of protection and ownership

4. **Creation and Worship** - Why worshiping the Creator matters in the final conflict
5. **Religious Liberty** - Historical and prophetic significance of church-state separation
6. **Revelation 17-18** - Babylon's identity and fall; the call to "come out"
7. **Revelation 12** - The woman, dragon, and remnant church
8. **Daniel 11-12** - Detailed end-time scenario leading to deliverance

Cross-reference with previous study guides:

- **Daniel 2** - Four kingdoms prophecy establishing historicist interpretation
- **Daniel 7** - Four beasts and judgment scene
- **Daniel 9** - Messiah's timeline proving prophetic precision
- **The Little Horn** - Identifying the first beast (papal Rome)

Historical Studies:

- The Inquisition and Dark Ages persecution
- Protestant Reformation (why the Reformers identified the papacy as antichrist)
- American founding documents and religious liberty
- Religious liberty erosion in modern times
- Current ecumenical movement toward Rome

May the Holy Spirit open your eyes to see, your ears to hear, and your heart to receive the truth that will prepare you for the final crisis.

"Here is the patience of the saints; here are those who keep the commandments of God and the faith of Jesus." - Revelation 14:12

This study guide is based on Bible Study #6 from Sanctuary Door Ministry (sanctuarydoorministry.com). All Scripture quotations are taken directly from the source material. This guide expands on the biblical foundation using the principle of "Scripture interprets Scripture" (Sola Scriptura).

For additional studies and resources, visit: sanctuarydoorministry.com